

Speakon

Loudspeakers have worked with a lot of connectors, but one particular connector suspended them all. The mighty Speakon connector was designed and originally manufactured by Neutrik specially for loudspeakers. Tra-



Speakon connectors

ditionally loudspeakers were either connected by 6.35 mm phone connectors or sometimes XLRs. But because contact areas were too less in traditional connectors, the need for a new standard arose. Apart from being more capable, Speakons are also quite well designed. The contact pins of both male and female ends are placed inside a cavity. This reduces chances of coming in contact with strong currents travelling to and from loudspeakers.

Speakons work with poles arranged in two concentric circles. The inner ones are called + poles and the outer ones are called - poles. They come in three configurations - 2, 4 and 8 poles. 4 pole configuration enables bi-amping without two separate cables and 8 does similar for tri-amping and even quad-amping. Speakons are found in most loudspeakers and amps.

TOSLINK

In 1983 Toshiba came up with TOSLINK, an optical fiber connector based on Sony Philips Digital Interconnect Format (S/PDIF). TOSLINK is used for transferring high-fidelity audio at extremely low latencies. It can carry compressed signal for surround sound or two channels of uncompressed audio for amplifying receivers. The only problem, it doesn't support major modern formats, including some lossless ones.



TOSLINK connectors